

Gaze lifted but
neck does not
reach back

Dropping head
back increases
risk of vertebral
artery damage
and stroke



Vertebral artery

Cardiovascular risk

There have been rare reports of injury in cervical hyperextension, including joint damage, impaired blood flow, and stroke. The risk is increased for the elderly, though more women in their 20s–40s are having strokes. Risk factors include prolonged use of birth control, migraines, pregnancy, and smoking.



Stretches
sternocleidomastoid

Strengthens
rhomboids
and trapezius

Stretches
pectoralis
major

Stretches
serratus
anterior

Counteract flexion dominance

Our lifestyles place us in flexion-dominant positions when typing, texting, driving, cooking, and more. Over time such postures lead to muscle weakness and tightness. Camel pose directly counteracts these patterns through controlled extension of your spine, shoulders, and hips. Backbends also tend to be energizing and a mood booster to combat fatigue.

Hands can
grasp ankles,
if accessible

Quadriceps
engage while
lengthening

**POSTERIOR-
LATERAL VIEW**